



The Twelve Jobs You Shouldn't **Still** Be Doing

What an AI chief of staff actually takes off a founder's desk, why a chat window can't do it no matter how well you prompt, and the leverage that shows up once it's running.

AREK RAINCZUK
FIFTH CASTLE MEDIA

The problem was never that it wrote badly.

The day ChatGPT came out I was all over it. Prompt engineering, projects, custom instructions, the lot. I run two video production companies and I'm a scientist by training, so learning a system doesn't scare me. And I'll say the thing most people selling AI won't: it's good. Work at it and it writes a genuinely decent email, better than a lot of what gets sent. The first time it remembered something about me I hadn't just told it, I sat back in my chair. If you've got good at it, that's a real skill and you did the work. I hit a ceiling anyway, and it had nothing to do with the quality of the writing.

Here's the ceiling. Everything it makes lands back on your desk. Prompt, wait, read, copy, paste, fix, send. You're still the one carrying every piece of work across, so your day is capped at whatever you can personally push through a text box. And the memory, impressive as it is, remembers things about you. It doesn't hold your business: every client, every price, every promise, every goal, every standard, every rule, live and acted on. Those are different things, and the second one is what a business actually runs on.

What I run now gets through roughly five times as many things in a day as I used to. Not typing five times faster. Five times as many finished things, because the work moves while I'm not at the desk. That's the whole argument of this document, and rather than ask you to take a number on faith, I'll show you the mechanism so you can judge it yourself.

What follows is written for someone who hasn't bought anything and might never. The first part is the useful bit: twelve jobs an AI chief of staff genuinely takes off a founder's desk, described concretely enough that you can hold each one against your own week. Then why a chat window can't do them however well you prompt, what "built around your business" actually requires from you, and what it costs. There's a section on who this isn't for, and I mean it.

Somewhere along the way I stopped opening chat windows and started running a business. I haven't opened one this year.

AREK RAINCZUK

One thing before you start. Everything below that sounds like a result is either mine, documented across my own two companies, or a founder's own words with their permission attached. The leverage I'm describing is what this system is built to do and what I've measured in my own week. How much of it lands in yours depends on what you put in, which is the honest answer and also the point of the section on what you bring.

The work that sits between you and getting paid

Each of these is a chain that used to run through you end to end, and now doesn't. Read them for the missing middle, because that's where the leverage sits.

01 From hanging up to a proposal that's ready to send

You finish a call. It has already read the transcript, so there is no briefing step and nothing for you to write up. It knows your pricing logic, your layout, the delivery methods you offer and the tone you use at that stage, so what comes back is a proposal, priced and formatted, waiting for you to check. Gone: the notes, the hunt for last year's version, the rebuild of the pricing table, the hour at nine at night.

The tell that it's working is a strange one. I've held a proposal back a day so the client didn't think I'd dashed it off in four minutes.

LEVERAGE Same-day proposals, on your best format, not your eleven o'clock one.

STILL YOURS The number, and the send.

02 Every record true, from one sentence

You say "they've paid". It checks the source system before it believes you, then updates the revenue record, the pipeline row, the business snapshot and the log in one pass. A timesheet arrives and it splits the lines across two companies, works out the super and writes both payroll records. Gone: the twenty minutes of opening four files, and the fortnight of drift when you don't.

LEVERAGE Your records are true on a Tuesday afternoon, not just at month end, so every decision after that is made on real numbers.

STILL YOURS The judgement calls. It surfaces mismatches rather than overwriting them.

03 Where you actually stand, without asking

The truth about your money lives in several places and none of them agree by Thursday. It pulls from all of them and reconciles the drift against its own last snapshot. Tamir's caught that its picture had gone stale, rebuilt it from the live system, and binned a follow-up email drafted off the bad figures. Nobody asked it to check.

LEVERAGE The reconciliation happens whether or not you remembered to want it, so the error gets caught before a client sees it.

STILL YOURS The decisions the numbers ask for.

The work that happens after the phone rings

04 Enquiry to booked, before you've seen it

An enquiry lands while you're on site. It recognises what it is, drafts the next-steps email in your voice, offers real times from your calendar, books the one they pick, sends the welcome and creates the record. The whole distance between an enquiry arriving and a meeting existing collapses: the reply you'd have written that evening, the four messages agreeing a time, the note to yourself to add them to the system.

LEVERAGE You answer first, every time, in your best register rather than your rushed one. Most jobs go to whoever replied first, not whoever was best.

STILL YOURS Approving the send, and reading who deserves a phone call.

05 A meeting becomes everything a meeting should produce

It reads the full transcript rather than a summary, matches it to the right client, files the note, turns every commitment you made out loud into a dated task with an owner, moves the next-action date and drafts the follow-up. One twenty-four minute call of mine produced a filed note, an updated pipeline row, two emails across two businesses and three logged threads. What's missing is the hour of writing-up that normally decides whether any of it happens.

LEVERAGE Every meeting produces its full output every time, including the ones that would have evaporated because the next call started.

STILL YOURS The conversation itself.

06 Nothing slips, and you stop carrying the list

A standing sweep runs across the inbox, the meetings and the commitments, and finds the email nobody answered, the meeting nobody followed up, and the prospect genuinely due a second touch, filtered from the ones legitimately on hold. What goes is the list you carry in your head between the shower and the desk, and the hour each week rebuilding it.

LEVERAGE Second touches actually happen. That's the leakiest point in most businesses I've looked at, mine included, and it leaks through memory rather than judgement.

STILL YOURS Deciding when a prospect is done.

The work that turns one input into many things

07 A yes becomes a running project

The client signs. Before you've told anyone, the folder exists, the records are updated, the project structure is built with owners and dates against each step, the contractor briefs are written and the delivery emails are drafted. The half-day of setup that usually happens three days late has already happened.

LEVERAGE Every project starts on the same structure, so the busy ones get the same handling as the calm ones. That's where delivery quality quietly comes from.

STILL YOURS The creative and the relationship.

08 One decision, implemented everywhere

I said out loud that school pick-up is mine and I take no meetings after three. That sentence travelled forward into how the system works from then on, and backward into the website, the templates, the calendar rules, the hours on my booking page and the documents already written. Four places, no visits, and none of the ones I'd have forgotten.

LEVERAGE A decision costs one sentence instead of an afternoon, so you make the ones you'd otherwise keep deferring. A decision made is a decision implemented.

STILL YOURS Making the call.

09 One session becomes a month of output

One recording session of mine produced a long-form video, two vertical ads, captions, music, three platform formats, a website embed, six paid ads and twenty-seven scheduled posts. Every hand-off in between vanished: the brief, the edit list, the caption pass, the resizing, the scheduling. So don't ask it for one social post. Ask for three months scheduled ahead, and social comes off your radar.

LEVERAGE The eighteenth post is made to the same standard as the first, because the standard is written down rather than depending on how much of you is left.

STILL YOURS Being the one on camera.

The work that happens while you're somewhere else

10 The morning that already happened

Overnight the mail is read and the senders looked up, replies are staged, the money is reconciled and the overdue work is surfaced. What reaches you is one message: what matters, with a recommended action against each item. The first ninety minutes of the day, the ones you spend working out what the day is, are already spent.

LEVERAGE You start at the decisions rather than the sorting, and you start there on the tired mornings as well as the good ones.

STILL YOURS Choosing what to ignore.

11 Work that continues when you don't

You approve a plan and walk away from it. It runs while you're with clients, on a shoot, or asleep. Tamir has his hunting grants overnight and connecting them to the right organisations by the time he sits down. The block of your own time the work used to need is simply not spent, and that's the mechanism underneath everything else on this list.

LEVERAGE Your day stops being the ceiling on how much gets finished. Work you'd never have started, because there was no gap for it, now runs in the gap.

STILL YOURS The approval, and leaving the machine on. That's the honest catch nobody mentions.

12 It fixes what annoys you

Every complaint you make about it gets collected. Once a week it comes back with the fixes, and it writes the rules so the same thing can't happen twice. Tamir's tracks every time he swears at it. The friction you'd normally put up with for a year, then work around forever, gets removed in the week you notice it.

LEVERAGE The work gets better on its own over months. Nothing else you buy improves the longer you own it.

STILL YOURS The complaining. It's the most useful thing you'll do.

More work, and better work, every time

The school pick-up ripple in 08 is the shape of the whole thing. One sentence, spoken once, and four places updated without a visit. That's the difference between something that answers you and something that works for you.

Now the part that gets undersold. The multiplier isn't only that more gets done. It's what happens to the work you'd otherwise have let slide. Every business has a marginal piece of work: the eighteenth social post, the follow-up to a prospect who probably won't buy, the delivery note on a small job, the proposal you'd have rushed at eleven at night. Today those get skipped or done badly. Now they get done properly, to the same standard as the first one, because the standard is written down and applied every time instead of depending on how much of you is left at the end of the day. That consistency is itself a form of leverage, and it compounds. Every client sees your best format. A year of that is a different business.

**I'm probably working less on the stuff I don't want to do.
I'm months ahead with my biz growth. I'm three times as fast.**

TAMIR BERKMAN, FOUNDER, BERKMAN ACADEMY

What the same coverage would cost you as people

Price the twelve as hires. An operations manager to keep the records true and the projects moving. An executive assistant for the inbox, the calendar and the follow-ups. A marketing coordinator for the content and the scheduling. That's not a hire you were ever going to make, which is the point: this is the one you can.

I'm not going to tell you what this will make you, because I don't know your business and anyone claiming otherwise is guessing. Here's the arithmetic, and you can finish it. One second touch that would have been forgotten, on a deal you'd price in five figures, is worth several times the build on its own. So is one proposal that goes out the same afternoon instead of the following week, on a job you'd have lost to whoever was quicker. Those are single events. The twelve above run every week, and none of them depend on you being at the desk.

WORTH DOING EVEN IF YOU NEVER BUILD ONE

Take the twelve above and mark each one A, B or C. A means it's handled and you're happy. B means it happens, badly or late. C means it doesn't happen at all and you know it's costing you. Most founders I show this to come back with two As. The Cs are usually 06, 09 and 12, and they're usually the ones nearest the money.

A chat window only exists while you're typing into it

If you're good at chat, nothing here is a knock on you or on the tool. I used it hard for two years and got a lot out of it. But there's a ceiling, it isn't a quality ceiling, and once you can name it the whole thing makes sense.

It remembers you. It doesn't hold your business.

The memory is the part everyone is impressed by, and fairly. It picks up how you like things written and what you're working on. That's recall about you. A business runs on something else: every client and what's been done for them, every price and the reasoning underneath it, the promise you made out loud on a Tuesday, the standard you hold work to, the lines you don't cross. Held live and acted on, not recited when asked. Projects and saved prompts get you closer, and I used them properly, but they're a handful of notes stuck to the outside of the thing. They don't grow, and they were never built to carry a whole business.

The work still lands back on your desk

Prompt, wait, read, copy, paste, fix, send. Every good answer becomes one more thing for you to carry across. That's assistance, and assistance has a hard limit: your day can only hold as much work as you can personally push through it. A chat window can only ever exist while you're typing into it. Close the laptop and nothing is happening. That single sentence is the whole difference.

What leverage actually looks like

A system runs in the background, or as a session you set going and walk away from. Work progresses while you're on a shoot, on the school run, asleep. That's the mechanism that makes five times as many finished things in a day arithmetically possible, and there's no version of it a chat window can do, however well you prompt. Two things come with it. It discerns, judging what genuinely needs you and handling the rest, because asking you about everything is just a slower way of doing it yourself. And it's broad: one system across the whole business rather than a tool per task, so what it learns in your quoting shows up in your follow-ups.

Chat is simply not the right tool. It's like trying to build a deck with a screwdriver. For running a business it won't do.

TAMIR BERKMAN, FOUNDER, BERKMAN ACADEMY

Levels, so you can place yourself

Being good at chat is level one, and it's a real skill. Projects, custom instructions and a prompt library you've tuned, call that level two, and most founders who tell me they're across AI have done that work properly. The level above holds its own memory of the business, reads and writes its own records, and carries out work while you're elsewhere. That's the jump, and it's bigger than the one from no AI to chat. It's also where the public conversation stopped, which is why hardly anyone tells you it's there.

You're not buying software. You're teaching a hire.

"Bespoke" is one of those words that usually means nothing, so here's what it means here: the value isn't in the architecture, it's in what goes into it. Two founders can start from the same foundation and end up with systems that behave nothing alike, because they brought different things to it.

What you bring is this.

Your prices, and how you get to them

Not a rate card. The reasoning. Why a job is \$4,000 and not \$2,500, what pushes it up, what you throw in, what you refuse to discount, how you handle GST, when you walk away. Most founders have never said this out loud in one sitting. Doing it is worth the session on its own.

Your voice, from things you've actually sent

Real emails, real proposals, real messages, the good ones and the ones you'd write again. Voice is learned from evidence, not from adjectives. Telling a system to be "warm and professional" produces exactly the beige nothing you'd expect. Feeding it thirty of your own sent emails produces something your clients don't clock as written by anything other than you.

Your clients and what you've promised each of them

Who they are, what's been done, what's outstanding, what was said on a call that never made it into writing, who's difficult about what. This is the part that lives only in your head today, and it's the reason everything routes through you.

Your tools, as they already are

Whatever you run on now. The point is that it works with what you've got rather than asking you to migrate to something new in the same month you're learning a new way of working. If a tool of yours is holding you back we'll talk about it, but not in week one.

Your rules

The lines you don't cross. Nothing goes to a client without you seeing it. Never quote below X. Never book me after three on a school day. Always flag anything with a legal implication. These are the ones that turn it from a clever assistant into something you can actually let off the leash.

Your standard for "good"

What a great proposal looks like versus an acceptable one. Which of your own past jobs you'd hold up as the benchmark. Correcting it when it gets something wrong is how it learns, the same way it works with a new team member, and it sticks the first time.

None of this is technical. All of it is stuff you already know and have never written down. That's the actual work of the build, and it's why I can't do it for you while you're out.

Four short sessions, on your machine, with me over your shoulder

Four sessions over about a fortnight, two a week, on Google Meet, then two follow-ups after you are running it. Roughly four and a half to six hours in the room all up. Short sessions on purpose, because this is easier in small doses with a couple of days of using it in between.

What I do

I bring the architecture and six months of my own mistakes, research and fine-tuning, so you don't repeat any of it. You start at about level seven out of ten on day one rather than at zero. I ask you the questions that get what's in your head onto the page, I set it up while you watch, and I tell you honestly when something isn't worth doing yet.

What you do

Talk, record, approve. You explain how your business works, out loud, the way you'd explain it to a new employee who's sharp but knows nothing about you. You bring real material: recent emails, a proposal you're proud of, your actual price list, a live problem from this week. And you use it between sessions, because the friction you hit on your own Tuesday is what session four is for.

Where it runs

On your own machine, Mac or PC, in plain instructions you own. Not on my server, not in a platform you rent from me. If you and I never speak again, everything keeps working.

What "done" means

Done isn't when I stop turning up. Done is the session where you build something in it yourself, unaided, while I sit there and say nothing. That moment is the actual deliverable. Every founder I've worked with can name the day it happened.

After that there's on-demand support when you get stuck, and a thirty-day window where I'm on the end of a message. The goal I'm building towards the whole time is that you stop needing me. My job is to make myself unnecessary, and I can't claim that and also design you into a retainer.

THE HONEST BIT

The build is a fortnight. The teaching carries on after that, and one of my clients said it better than I have: "It takes more than a fortnight teaching it." He's right. The architecture goes in during the fortnight, then you're onboarding it into your business for a while after, the same as you would with a good hire. Anyone telling you it's finished and perfect on day fourteen is selling you something.

The questions founders ask me on the first call

Arek spent two days with my members last week and handed over the entire AI operating system he's built, no holding back. The room shifted in front of me: people who came in unsure walked out building.

DEN LENNIE, FOUNDER, VIDEO BUSINESS ACCELERATOR

Do I need to be technical?

No, and I'd rather you weren't trying to be. Your three jobs are talk, record, approve. If you can explain your business out loud to a person, you can teach it to a chief of staff. What you do need is baseline computer confidence: you already run your business from a laptop, you can install an app and follow a set-up prompt without dread. That's the real qualifier, not coding.

What does it actually run on?

Your own computer, Mac or PC. It runs on today's best models, currently Claude, and it isn't welded to them. When a sharper model lands, yours gets sharper the same week, with no rebuild and no new invoice. That's the opposite of most software you buy, which is at its best the day you buy it.

What happens to my data?

It stays on your machine, in files you own and can read, not in a database I control. There's no client portal of mine that holds your business. If you're in a field with real confidentiality obligations, and several of the founders I work with are, we set the boundaries in the build: what it's allowed to hold, what never goes near it, what always needs your eyes first. Those rules are part of the thing, not a policy document you file away.

What if I get stuck after you leave?

You ask it. That sounds glib, and it's the honest answer: the system is the thing that helps you extend the system, and by the end of the build you'll have done that in front of me. Beyond that, you've got on-demand support during the build and a thirty-day window after. And there's no lock-in, so if you want out, you take everything with you, because it was always on your machine.

What does it cost?

The build is \$5,500 ex GST. It's not a subscription, there's no retainer behind it, and you own what we build. It's per person, so if there's more than one founder, each of you gets your own build. Payment is half to lock the dates, half on go-live.

How long until it's actually useful?

Useful in the first week, because the first session gets it holding real context about your business. Genuinely load-bearing takes longer, closer to a month of you using it and correcting it. I'd rather tell you that now than have you feel misled in week two. The founders who get the most out of it are the ones who bring it a real problem every couple of days early on.

Won't this all be out of date in six months?

The opposite, and this is the part people find counter-intuitive. It isn't an app that ships and then ages. It's a set of instructions that runs on whatever the best model is that week, so it improves underneath you without you doing anything. Most tools lose value from the day you buy them. This one compounds.

FOUNDERS WHO'VE BUILT THEIR OWN

"It feels like having a second set of hands rather than another app to babysit."

ISAAC VIGLIONE, BLOOM FILMS

"It's like having an extra person on the team who knows the whole business. The best part is it sounds like us, not like a robot."

JESS VIEIRA, ZARCO CREATIVE

"I've built a system that actually runs the way my brain works and holds my whole business."

JOSE FERNANDEZ, SPECK OF DUST

"Arek helped us build the foundations of an AI operating system that is already delivering real value."

ORVILLE, GREATER VISUALS

"Arek really unlocked how to connect it all together and make it work for me, not just with me."

MATT SMOLEN, BALLOON TREE PRODUCTIONS

Six reasons I'd tell you not to do it

I'd rather lose a sale than run a build that was never going to work. If you recognise yourself below, don't book the call, and I'll say the same thing on it if it comes up.

— You want it done for you

This is done with you. If your intention is to hand over your business and collect a working system in a fortnight, you'll be disappointed and I'll have wasted your money. The value comes out of your head. There's no version of this where you're not in the room.

— You can't give it the hours

Four sessions plus using it in between, and two follow-ups after. If the next month is a shoot schedule from hell or you're about to go overseas, wait. It'll still be here, and it'll be better.

— Computers are a genuine struggle

I've learned this one the hard way. If installing software and following a set-up prompt is a real barrier rather than a mild annoyance, this build will frustrate both of us. Not technical is fine. Not comfortable with a computer at all isn't.

— You've got a big team and want everyone on it

This is built for the founder who's the bottleneck, and for small teams where that founder stays at the controls. A rollout across a large team is a different piece of work with different questions, and I'd scope it separately rather than pretend this is it.

— You want another subscription to hand off and forget

You're hiring, not installing. You brief it, you correct it, and you keep teaching it. Several of my clients have cancelled other tools after building theirs, which tells you what it replaces, but none of them got there by leaving it alone.

— You won't say out loud how you really price and decide

Some founders can't, or won't, articulate the reasoning behind their own numbers and standards. That's fair, plenty of it is instinct. But this build runs on exactly that material, and without it you'll get a polite general-purpose assistant instead of a chief of staff.

THE NEXT STEP

Bring me your messiest week

If any of the twelve jobs landed, the next move is a short call. It's me on it, not a salesperson, and I'll show you my own system doing real work rather than describing it. Bring the week you've got, not a tidied-up version. Worst case, you leave knowing what an agentic system would do in your business and you go and build it yourself.

What you'd be building is one system across the whole business, put together to get more out of knowledge work than anything else you can buy right now. Not a wrapper, not a prompt pack, not another subscription.

THE BUILD / PER PERSON

\$5,500 + GST

Four sessions and two follow-ups, per person. If there's more than one of you, each founder gets their own, and connecting them is a separate piece of work we scope once we know how you operate together. Half to lock your dates, half on go-live.

BOOK A CALL

Thirty minutes, with me, no pitch deck

portal.fifthcastle.media/schedule/call-with-arek

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